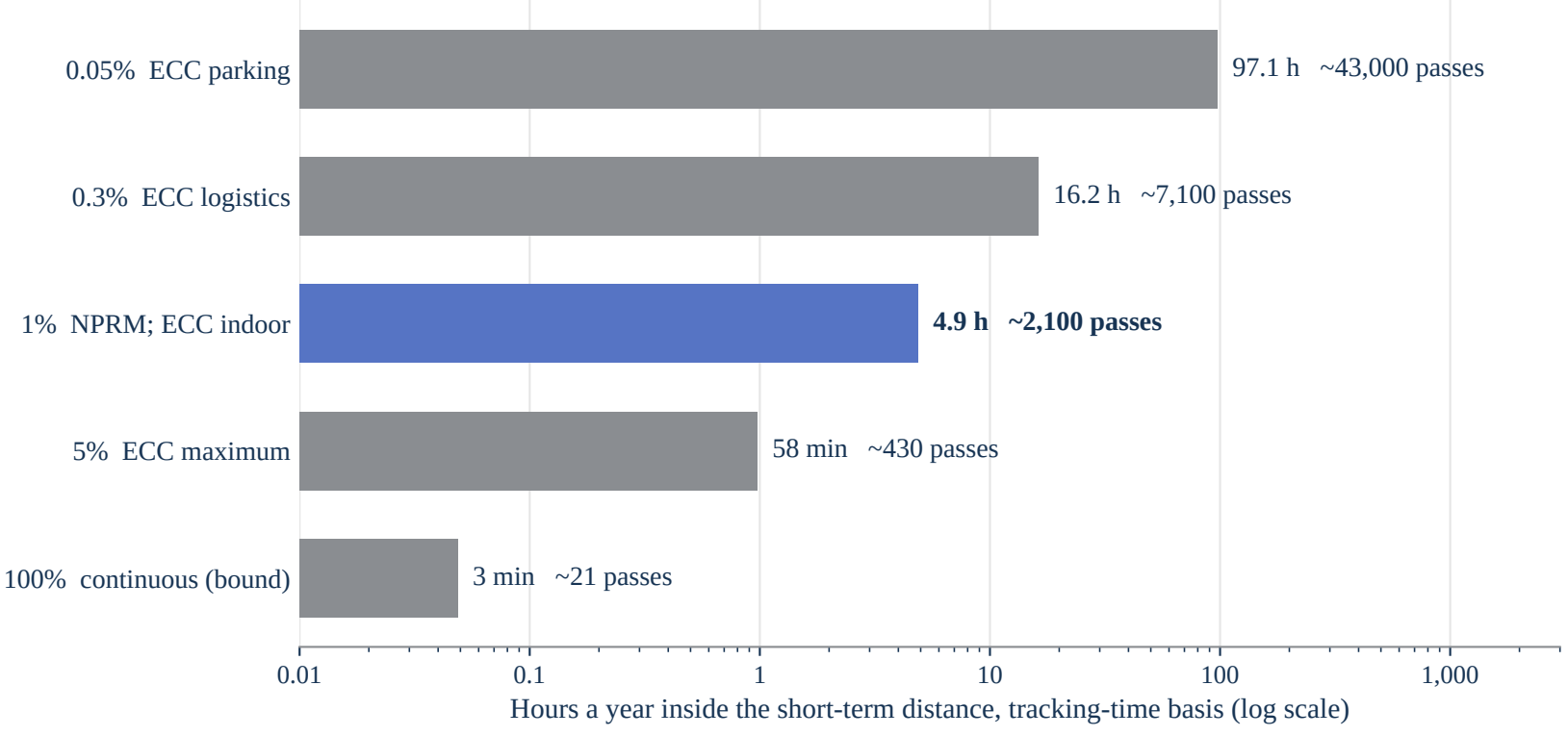
At a 1% duty cycle, a drone would need 4.9 hours a year inside the beam during passes: about 2,130 perfectly placed passes at the NASA station

Wallops NEN 11.3 m. Hours a year a drone must spend inside the short-term distance, in the direction the dish points while it tracks, to use up the short-term allowance (0.005% of tracking time). Passes (derived) = hours / 8.2 s, the median time the beam stays on a hovering drone at the best spot; 18.5 passes a day.



Source: nicklasorte/7GHz_UWB_NRPM, threshold_distance_rev1.m and beam_dwell_rev1.m via example_bridge_rev1.m, run of November 11, 2026 (docs/bridge_results/hours_to_allowance_wallops.csv, beam_dwell_passes_wallops.csv).